CO-AUTHORSHIP CONTRACT AGREEMENT

This Contract is made and entered into by and between:

STUDENTS:

1. Charles Adrian L. Cabil of legal age, single/married, residing at Purok 3 Centro, Labogon, Mandaue City, Cebu, 6014;

2. Mark Lee Duyag of legal age, single/married, residing at Soong, Mactan, Lapu-Lapu City, Cebu, 6015;

3. Ignacio Maurice P. Vergara of legal age, single/married, residing at Isuya, Mactan, Lapu-Lapu City, Cebu, 6015;

hereinafter collectively referred to as the "Students," and

RESEARCH ADVISER:

Darwin Espera of legal age, single/married, residing at A.C. Cortes Ave, Looc, Mandaue City, Cebu, 6014 hereinafter referred to as the "Research Adviser."

The Students and the Research Adviser are each, at times, individually referred to in this Agreement as a "party" and collectively as the "parties."

1. Background and Purpose

This Co-Authorship Agreement is made to formally document the collaborative efforts of the Students and the Research Adviser on a scholarly work resulting from the Students' research project conducted under the guidance and supervision of the Research Adviser as part of their academic requirements.

The purposes of this Agreement are as follows:

- To acknowledge and clarify the roles, responsibilities, and intellectual contributions of both the Students and the Adviser;
- To establish a clear understanding of authorship credit and order for any resulting publications or presentations;
- To promote transparency, academic integrity, and ethical research practices; and
- To prevent potential misunderstandings or disputes related to authorship, contributions, or rights to the work.

The Students have undertaken or will undertake the research project titled DOCUCENTER: A Self-Service Kiosk Document Processing Station with Real-

Time Monitoring and Automated Payment System as part of the requirements for obtaining the degree of Bachelor of Science Major in Computer Enginering at the University of Cebu Lapu-Lapu and Mandaue, Mandaue City, Philippines.

The Research Adviser undertakes to provide significant guidance, mentorship, and scholarly input throughout the research process. The parties acknowledge their respective contributions to the completion and potential publication of the Students' thesis or dissertation.

2. Acknowledgment of Co-Researcher Status

The Students agree to recognize the Research Adviser as a co-researcher in the published version of the thesis or dissertation when it is submitted for publication in a refereed journal. Furthermore, the Students agree that the Adviser may be credited as a co-author of the published work, provided that the Adviser has made substantial contributions to its intellectual content—such as assisting in the design of experiments, analyzing data, and shaping the overall direction and substance of the paper.

To be listed as a co-author, the Adviser must also accept shared responsibility for the integrity and outcomes of the published work.

3. Conditions for Co-Researcher Status

The Research Adviser's contributions must be significant and relevant to the intellectual, methodological, or academic content of the thesis or dissertation. Such contributions may include, but are not limited to, the following:

3.1. Conception and design, acquisition of data, or analysis and interpretation of data;
3.2. Drafting of articles based on the research/thesis or revising them critically for important intellectual content;
3.3. Writing substantial sections of the paper or editing the final version of the manuscript; and
3.4. Reviewing, commenting, and approving the final version to be published.

The Adviser will be given proper recognition in authorship, including appropriate placement of their name and affiliation in accordance with standard academic conventions. The Adviser will be involved in the review and approval of the manuscript before submission.

4. Publication Process

The Students shall be responsible for the primary submission of the manuscript to the refereed journal, including the completion of necessary revisions, as guided by the Research Adviser. The Adviser will provide input, feedback, and support throughout the

publication process, including reviewing drafts, suggesting revisions, and assisting with submission.

5. Right to Withdraw

If, at any point, the Research Adviser determines that their contribution has been insufficient or does not warrant co-authorship, the Adviser has the right to withdraw consent for co-authorship. The Students will respect this decision and adjust the manuscript accordingly.

6. Intellectual Property and Copyright

The Students retain ownership of the intellectual property and copyright of the thesis or dissertation, subject to any agreements made with the university or funding organizations. The Adviser's involvement as a co-researcher does not transfer any rights to the intellectual property but acknowledges their academic contribution.

7. Termination of Agreement

This Agreement may be terminated by either party under the following conditions:

7.1. Mutual Agreement. Both parties may mutually agree to terminate this Agreement at any time, with any pending publication or project handled accordingly.

7.2. Failure to Meet Responsibilities. Either party may terminate if the other fails to fulfill their obligations as outlined herein.

7.3. Academic or Institutional Issues. If the Students are no longer enrolled or the Adviser is no longer affiliated with the institution, either party may terminate upon mutual agreement.

7.4. Ethical or Legal Violations. The Agreement may be terminated immediately for violations of ethical or legal standards, such as plagiarism or academic dishonesty.

Upon termination, the parties shall decide the disposition of any completed work and whether publication shall proceed.

8. Additional Provisions

8.1. Liability. Each party shall hold the other free and harmless from any liabilities arising from this Agreement, except those resulting from a party's negligence or misconduct.

8.2. Effectivity. This Agreement takes effect upon signing and remains valid until terminated under the provisions stated herein.

8.3. Separability. Invalidity of any provision shall not affect the validity of the remaining clauses.

8.4. Amendment. Any amendment must be in writing and signed by all parties.

8.5. Assignment. No party may transfer rights or obligations under this Agreement without prior written consent of the other.

8.6. Representations. Each signatory warrants that they have full authority to execute this

Agreement.

8.7. Inclusion of Panel Members. The Students agree to include, as co-authors in any publishable version, panel members who substantially contributed to the research.

9. Dispute Resolution

Any disputes shall first be resolved through open dialogue. If unresolved, the matter may be submitted to mediation or arbitration in accordance with the rules of the University of Cebu.

10. Miscellaneous

This document represents the entire Agreement between the parties and supersedes any prior understandings. Any amendments must be written and signed by all parties.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the parties have executed this Agreement this ____ day of _____, 20____.

STUDENTS:

1. Charles Adrian L. Cabil Signature: _____
Date: February 19, 2026

2. Mark Lee Duyag Signature: _____
Date: February 19, 2026

3. Ignacio Maurice P. Vergara Signature: _____
Date: February 19, 2026

RESEARCH ADVISER:

Name: Engr. Darwin Espera Signature: _____
Date: February 19, 2026

20 FEB 2026 SUBSCRIBED AND SWORN to before me this _____ at Lapu-Lapu City, Cebu, Philippines. Affiant/s exhibited to me his / her / their DRIVERS LICENSE ID NO 606-24-003472 valid until 7-19-2028

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Series of 2026.

ATTY. PATRICK I. ABING
Roll of Attorneys No. 75605
Notary Public for and in the City of Lapu-Lapu
Notarial Commission No. 795-L until Dec. 31, 2026
IBP OR No. INV 583128 - Jan. 2, 2026 - Cebu Province
PTR No. 1449360A - Jan. 5, 2026 - Lapu-Lapu City
Amores Apt., Lopez Jaena St., Poblacion, Lapu-Lapu City
Email Address: swerver2008@gmail.com